

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 6 2
♥ 8 7 3
♦ K 9 7 4 3
♣ K J

♠ K 10 9 3
♥ A K Q 5
♦ A 8
♣ A 8 6



♠ 8 5
♥ 10 4 2
♦ Q J 10 5
♣ Q 10 9 4

♠ A J 7 4
♥ J 9 6
♦ 6 2
♣ 7 5 3 2

West	North	East	South
	2NT	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	3NT
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 4

Partner's 3♣ bid is Stayman; with 4 cards in both Majors you respond 3♥. Partner now bids 3NT.

Partner's 3♣ bid is Stayman; with 4 cards in both Majors you respond 3♥. Partner now bids 3NT.

Partner would not use Stayman unless he held a 4-card Major suit himself. Since he didn't like your ♥s it follows that he must have 4 ♠s.

So you correct the 3NT contract to 4♠.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♦Q.

If you had left it in 3NT you'd have 8 top tricks and a ♠ finesse for 9.

But you're in 4♠.

If you can guess the ♠Q your problems are over. But just in case you dislike those 50% guesses, try to find a better Plan.

Another possibility is that a defender holds either a singleton or doubleton ♠Q so you can pick up the suit by leading ♠ A K. This is smaller than a 50% chance.

But there is more to the odds than that. Suppose you try the second possibility and play off both the ♠A and ♠K but the ♠Q does **NOT** drop. You are still not dead! You just leave the ♠Q out there and start on ♥s. As long as the defender who holds the ♠Q has at least 3 ♥s he will be unable to ruff until after you have discarded dummy's ♦ loser.

The extra chance makes this Plan your best hope.

You could have made the contract easily by playing West for the ♠Q.

You could have gone down easily by playing East for the ♠Q.

Or you could have made it whoever held the ♠Q by using the "improved" plan.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 7 3
 ♥ 5
 ♦ K Q 9 4 2
 ♣ 9 4 3

♠ A Q 5

♥ J 3

♦ A J 10 3

♣ Q J 10 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 4 2

♥ A Q 8 7 4 2

♦ 6

♣ K 7 5

♠ J 10 6

♥ K 10 9 6

♦ 8 7 5

♣ A 6 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

2♥

Dbl

All Pass

2♥ by East

To see all the hands

East is to play 2♥ Doubled.

This is the only Deal like this out of the 100.

No Declarer Plan for you to make, no tricks to look for.

Just play through the deal as you think it might go and see how many tricks you can set East. Enjoy.

Sometimes the opponents make overcalls which disrupt the smooth flow of your side's bidding. You and your partner need to have ways of dealing with these disruptions. One possibility is the **lebensohl** convention which is used a few times in these 100 Deals. There are lots of other methods out there, and you may not care for lebensohl. One of the big reasons we use it is that it includes a penalty double - some other methods use the double for other reasons.

So, in lebensohl an immediate double of their overcall of partner's 1NT opener is for penalties. Just like this one - punish them if they dare try to disrupt your bidding!

The contract is 2♥ doubled, played by East.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 5 3
♥ J 10 8 6
♦ Q 9 7 2
♣ 9 4

♠ A 6

♥ 9 7 2

♦ K 10 8 3

♣ A K Q 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 7 4 2

♥ A 5 4 3

♦ J 4

♣ 10 8 2

♠ K Q J 8

♥ K Q

♦ A 6 5

♣ J 7 6 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	4NT	Pass	1NT
All Pass			6NT

6NT by South
fall doubleton.

Partner's 4NT bid is not Blackwood, it is the Quantitative 4NT. He is unsure whether to bid 6NT or not, so is inviting you to do so.

With 15 points you are supposed to pass. With 17 points you are supposed to bid 6NT. Wouldn't you know it, 16 points. Today you feel bold, so you say 6NT.

South plays 6NT. West leads the ♥ J.

East plays the ♥ A and returns the ♥ 3.

Winner List: ♠ = 4 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 4 :: Total = 11

One trick is already lost and at first glance it looks like your only slim chance will be for the ♦ Q J to

But a dummy has a very important card, the ♥ 9. You know from the opening lead that West holds the ♥ 10, so if he happens to hold the only guard in ♦ s you will be able to squeeze him in the red suits.

You don't even have to do anything special. Play your 4 ♣ winners, then 3 ♠ winners.

Now play the ♠ J and watch West's discard. If he throws the ♥ 10 dummy's ♥ 9 will become a winner. If he doesn't throw the ♥ 10 then you know dummy's ♥ 9 is worthless so discard it and hope the ♦ s are good.

Squeeze plays can be complex to figure out and difficult to execute.

But not always. Sometimes they just happen, like this one. You were really hoping for the ♦ Q and ♦ J to fall and you fell into the squeeze instead.